

Windows Forensics Challenge - Investigation Notes

Administrative Accounts

Command: net localgroup administrators

Purpose: Find users with administrator privileges.

Finding: Jenny and ssm-user had admin privileges besides Administrator.

Lesson: Attackers often add accounts to the Administrators group for persistence.

Scheduled Task Investigation

Command: schtasks /query /fo LIST /v

Purpose: View all scheduled tasks.

Useful searches:

- schtasks /query /fo LIST /v | findstr /i "badr"

- schtasks /query /fo LIST /v | findstr /i "tmp"

Finding: Task 'Clean file system' ran C:\TMP\nc.ps1 -l 1348 daily.

Lesson: Never trust the task name; always inspect 'Task To Run'.

Netcat Listener

File: nc.ps1

Argument: -l 1348

Meaning: Listen for incoming connections on port 1348.

Answer: Local listening port = 1348.

User Logons

Command: net user John

net user Jenny

Finding: John logged on 03/02/2019 5:48:32 PM.

Finding: Jenny last logon = Never.

Event ID 4672

Location: Event Viewer -> Windows Logs -> Security

Filter: Event ID 4672

Meaning: Special privileges assigned to a new logon.

Purpose: Identify when administrator-level access was granted.

Mimikatz Discovery

Suspicious files: mim.exe and somethingwindows.dmp

Command: Get-Item C:\TMP\mim.exe | Format-List *

Purpose: View file metadata.

Finding: mim.exe likely renamed Mimikatz used for credential dumping.

C2 Server Investigation

Hosts file: C:\Windows\System32\drivers\etc\hosts

Finding: 76.32.97.132 google.com

Finding: 76.32.97.132 www.google.com

Conclusion: 76.32.97.132 identified as attacker C2 server.

Lesson: Google should not normally be manually mapped in hosts file.

Web Shell Investigation

Location: C:\inetpub\wwwroot

Files found: b.jsp, tests.jsp, shell.gif

Finding: Web shell extension = .jsp

Lesson: JSP files can execute server-side code and are often used as web shells.

Firewall Investigation

Tool: Windows Firewall with Advanced Security -> Inbound Rules

Finding: Suspicious rule allowed port 1337.

Answer: Last port opened by attacker = 1337.

DNS Poisoning

Hosts file redirected google.com to 76.32.97.132.

Attack type: DNS Poisoning / Hosts File Hijacking.

Targeted site: google.com.